

businesses might want to look for something more robust and secure, and this is a good alternative. It features authentication, detailed per-user or per-service logging, a good firewall, protocol specific restrictions, and much more. Overall it will give any systems admin the control he craves, while making sure your network is secure and that your users are not up to mischief. Implement this solution, and you're sure to dissuade any goofing-off online because of its comprehensive logging and report-generating capabilities. However, the feature you bosses will love the most is its AI Filtering—just choose to block adult, gambling, sports, chat, Web mail, and even job sites, and WinGate will use a little programmed AI and a rather large global database to prevent your users from accessing such content. No more feeding in individual sites to block—just let WinGate block them automatically. The bad news? You're going to have to cough up considerable cash for this gem: the licenses are priced by the amount of connected users, ranging from as little as three to an unlimited amount. Don't confuse this with the number of PCs you have, because if you have 100 PCs in your office, you could consider buying a license for 25 or 50 users, since not all 100 will be accessing the Net at the exact same time. Licenses available for WinGate standard are 3 / 6 / 12 concurrent users, and for the Professional version, 6 / 12 / 25 / 50 / 100 / 250 / 250+ concurrent users. Prices range from \$75 (Rs 3,375) for 3, \$200 (Rs 9,000) for 12, to \$1700 (Rs 76,500) for 250+ concurrent users.



Games

After the problem of e-goofing off, the most popular complaint was games. A lot of people have taken to playing games online (Yahoo! Games anyone?), but since more and more companies are filtering content and blocking access to such sites, Windows games have remained popular. *Solitaire* in particular is infamous for being the game of bored secretaries and employees, and most Windows games are just too much to resist—they're just sitting there in the Start Menu, begging to be played!



Get Rid Of Them / Control Them

There are several ways you can prevent access to Windows games. You could just uninstall them from your PCs by going to Add/Remove Programs (Start > Run > "appwiz.cpl") and then clicking on "Add/Remove Windows Components" on the left. Select "Accessories and Utilities" and then click Details. Uncheck Games and press OK > Next > Finish. Windows games will be uninstalled.

If you're running a Domain Controller (see Mayhem Management, *Digit* February 2007), you can uninstall these games from all PCs, and then prevent your employees from re-installing them.

If it's not just Windows games, but all games you want to prevent access to, you're going to need some software help...



Suggested Software

StopGame (www.askmesoft.com): Now here's a must-have software for all bosses... StopGame doesn't just block games; it allows

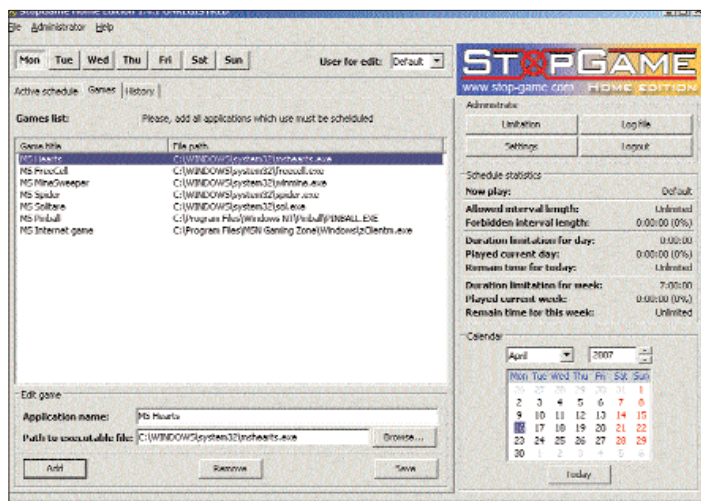
People use IM to make friends, date, flirt, learn about different cultures... problem is, so many people are doing so on company time, using company bandwidth!

you to completely control if and when your employees play them. This is the perfect retort to those slackers who claim to need a little relaxation at the fag end of a hectic day. If you remove the games, you'll get complaints; keep them and your employees goof off; but what if you could restrict access to games like *Solitaire*? Half an hour a day, four hours per week, only during official lunch hours... any sort of restriction is possible. If the employee tries to break the rules that you've set and start a game, poof—it just closes right down again. It's like you sitting there and pressing end-task time and again, without the maniacal laughter or evil giggling, of course! All you have to do is install the software, follow the instructions in the help files, add the games you want to block / restrict (Windows games or otherwise), and watch twitchy-fingered employees with withdrawal symptoms order that extra cup of coffee. You will need the StopGame Office version of course, available at www.askmesoft.com/stopgame_office.htm. It will cost you anywhere from \$18 to \$9 (Rs 800 to 400) per copy—depending on how many PCs you want to install it on. For example, four licenses will cost \$18 each, 15 will cost \$15 each, and 51 or more will cost \$9 each. We're sure our editor would love to get something like this to prevent us from playing *Quake III Arena* all the time, but unfortunately, he knows we geeks will just find a way around it! For most employees however, this is quite a foolproof solution.



Chat / IM

It's just so easy now, isn't it? We're sitting at our PCs chatting with people across the world. We can even have voice conversations for free, and see each other via webcams. Chat is a beautiful technology, loved by every mother and grandparent who has a child / relative abroad. It saves a bundle on phone calls as



Use StopGame, or similar software to prevent employees from playing games

well. People use it to make friends, date, flirt, learn about different cultures... problem is, so many people are doing so on company time, using company bandwidth! Most of the bosses we spoke used words we cannot publish to describe Instant Messengers (IMs).